improvements in Indo-Pakistani relations have resulted from nonnuclear strategic, domestic, and diplomatic factors. And he predicts that nuclear weapons' past effects on the regional security environment will destabilize South Asia in years to come.

In this chapter we shift our focus away from our disagreements to discuss three nuclear-related issues upon which we agree. First, we revisit the theoretical bases of our arguments and ask how far apart they actually are. We suggest that in truth our arguments share a number of important similarities and that the difference between our approaches is largely one of emphasis. Our assessments of nuclear weapons' effects on South Asia differ because we disagree as to which aspects of regional crisis behavior are most important; Ganguly believes that the relatively benign outcomes of Indo-Pakistani crises matter most, while Kapur focuses on the dangerous process of crisis outbreak and escalation.

Second, we discuss the impact that the possible Indian acquisition of ballistic missile defense capabilities would have on strategic stability in the region. We contend that such a course would likely prove to be destabilizing, increasing the incentives for arms racing and possibly for the first use of nuclear weapons.

Third, we examine the November 2008 terrorist attacks on Mumbai and discuss their implications for the future of Indo-Pakistani relations and regional security in South Asia. We argue that the Mumbai attacks point up the fundamental security problem facing South Asia in the future: Nonstate actors, whom Pakistan employed over past decades as asymmetric weapons against India, have taken on a life of their own. They now behave in ways that are not only damaging to India but also detrimental to Pakistan's national interests. Unfortunately, neither India nor Pakistan currently possesses the conventional military, intelligence, or policing capabilities needed to rein them in. And nuclear weapons, which facilitated Pakistan's original adoption of an asymmetric warfare strategy, are useless in combating militants; prevent large-scale Indian retaliation against Pakistan, which could make Islamabad's continued tolerance of anti-Indian militancy prohibitively costly; and pose security risks of their own. Devising a solution to this dilemma will constitute the region's main security challenge in coming years.